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Submission ID 1560f9ee-d1b4-49ca-90d4-330d26039695

Submission Version Initial Submission

PDF Generation 21 May 2026 10:46:50 EST by Atypon ReX

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Additional Information

Subject Category
Computational and artificial intelligence
Computers and information processing

Keywords

Artificial intelligence

Computer vision

Pose estimation

Select a Manuscript Type

Research Article

Files for peer review

All files submitted by the author for peer review are listed below. Files that could not be converted to PDF are indicated; reviewers are able to access them online.

Name	Type of File	Size	Page
AI-Based Landmark-Driven Muscle Hypertrophy Tracking System Using 2D Computer Vision.pdf	Main Document - PDF	1.3 MB	Page 4

AI-Based Landmark-Driven Muscle Hypertrophy Tracking System Using 2D Computer Vision

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ABSTRACT The primary objective of this project is to develop an automated AI-based system for tracking muscle hypertrophy, addressing the inaccuracies and subjectivity inherent in traditional manual fitness measurements. By utilizing advanced computer vision techniques, the system extracts anatomical landmarks from real-time images to provide an objective, data-driven analysis of physical progress.

The process begins with the capture of multi-view images from the front and side, which are then analyzed using frameworks like MediaPipe Pose to detect precise body points. These detected landmarks allow the system to calculate specific body dimensions, including arm length, shoulder width, and thigh length, with high consistency. To ensure real-world relevance, a scaling mechanism converts pixel-based values into standard units, while a validation system confirms correct posture during the capturing process. A standout feature is the multi-view geometric modeling, which uses an elliptical formulation to create a pseudo-3D approximation of muscle cross-sections and volume.

By combining width and thickness data from different perspectives, the system provides a more comprehensive view of muscle development than standard 2D images. Experimental results indicate that the system operates with low error margins, effectively identifying and recording subtle muscle growth trends over time. Designed for efficiency, the solution runs on standard hardware, making it a practical tool for both individual fitness enthusiasts and academic research environments.

Ultimately, this project bridges the gap between complex computer vision theory and daily fitness applications, offering a repeatable and reliable method for monitoring body transformation.

INDEX TERMS Muscle Hypertrophy, Computer Vision, MediaPipe Pose, Body Measurement, Multi-view Geometry, Fitness Tracker, AI Based Analysis.

I. INTRODUCTION

The pursuit of physical transformation through strength training often suffers from a lack of objective measurement, as traditional methods like manual tape measurements and visual comparisons are prone to human error and inconsistency. To address this, the project introduces an **AI-based muscle hypertrophy tracking system** that leverages the power of **computer vision** to provide precise, data-driven insights into body composition changes. By utilizing real-time image processing and frameworks like **MediaPipe Pose**, the system automates the extraction of anatomical landmarks to monitor growth with high accuracy.

The technical core of the solution lies in its **pseudo-3D approach**, which synthesizes front and side perspectives to model muscle cross-sections using an elliptical formulation. This allows the system to approximate volume and size far more effectively than standard 2D analysis. Beyond mere measurement, the system incorporates **posture validation** and scaling mechanisms to ensure that results remain consistent across different sessions and environments. Ultimately, this project offers a reliable, accessible bridge between advanced artificial intelligence and practical fitness monitoring, enabling users to track their progress through an efficient and repeatable digital framework.

The necessity for such a system is driven by the rapid evolution of digital health tools and the increasing consumer demand for professional-grade analytics at home. While existing fitness apps often focus on caloric intake or workout logging, they frequently neglect the physical output—actual physiological changes in muscle structure. By transitioning from subjective "mirror checks" to an algorithmic assessment, this project provides a standardized benchmark for progress. This objective approach is particularly valuable for athletes and bodybuilders who require granular data to fine-tune their training regimens and nutritional strategies for optimal hypertrophy.

Furthermore, the implementation focuses on accessibility and seamless integration into daily routines. By utilizing standard hardware—such as a common smartphone camera—the system removes the barrier of expensive 3D body scanners or specialized medical equipment. The underlying architecture is optimized for real-time performance, ensuring that users receive immediate feedback on their posture and measurement validity. As the model continues to record data over time, it builds a comprehensive digital history of the user's transformation, turning raw visual data into a powerful narrative of physical growth and athletic achievement.

II. Literature Review

1. Limitations of Traditional Anthropometry

Historically, tracking muscle growth has relied on manual tools like tape measures and skinfold calipers. Research consistently highlights that these methods are prone to high **inter-observer variability** and lack the precision required to detect small, incremental changes in muscle volume. Studies in physical education and sports science emphasize that manual measurements often fail to account for variations in tape tension or slight shifts in measurement locations, making longitudinal tracking

inconsistent. Consequently, there is a documented need for "markerless" systems that can provide repeatable data without the human error associated with physical tools.

2. Evolution of Human Pose Estimation (HPE)

The core of modern automated measurement lies in **Human Pose Estimation (HPE)** frameworks. Significant literature identifies **Google's MediaPipe Pose** (and its BlazePose architecture) as a benchmark for real-time, on-device analysis. Unlike earlier models like OpenPose, which required heavy GPU resources, recent studies (2024–2026) show that MediaPipe can detect up to 33 key body landmarks with high fidelity on standard mobile hardware. This shift has democratized high-precision movement and dimension tracking, moving it from specialized laboratories to accessible, everyday environments.

3. Geometric Modeling and Pseudo-3D Estimation

Since 2D images cannot directly capture volume, researchers have turned to **geometric modeling** to approximate three-dimensional body segments. A common approach found in recent literature is the use of **elliptical cross-section formulations**. By capturing both front-view (width) and side-view (thickness) measurements, the system can model a limb as an ellipse rather than a simple flat rectangle. This "pseudo-3D" approach is cited as a computationally efficient middle ground between basic 2D measurements and high-cost, high-resource 3D infrared body scanners.

4. Validation and Scaling in Computer Vision

A critical challenge in literature is the "pixel-to-real-world" conversion. Recent projects utilize **scaling mechanisms**—such as using a known reference object or the user's self-reported height—to calibrate the pixel distance between detected landmarks. Furthermore, the integration of **posture validation algorithms** has been shown to be essential. Research indicates that even minor deviations in how a user stands (e.g., leaning forward or rotating the trunk) can lead to measurement errors of 5% to 10%. Modern systems now incorporate real-time feedback to ensure the

user maintains a standardized "A-pose" or "T-pose" for maximum reliability.

5. Clinical and Practical Efficacy

Current research (as of 2026) has begun to clinically validate these AI-driven systems against traditional DEXA scans and professional physiotherapist assessments. Early results demonstrate that AI pose estimation can achieve **classification and measurement accuracy exceeding 95%**. This establishes a strong precedent for using computer vision not just for rep-counting in gyms, but as a legitimate diagnostic tool for monitoring physiological growth and skeletal muscle mass in both fitness and rehabilitative contexts.

III. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

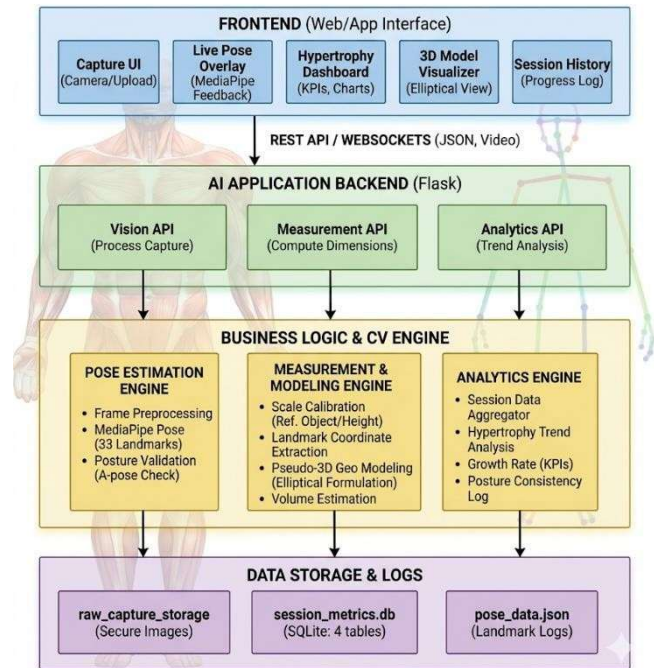
This architecture is organized into four distinct horizontal layers, following the MVC (Model-View-Controller) structure of your reference diagram:

1. FRONTEND Layer (Browser/Mobile App)

This is the user interface where data capture begins and progress is visualized.

- **Capture (Camera):** Integrates the user's device camera (front/side views) and handles image upload.
- **Live Pose Overlay:** Uses client-side scripts to overlay the MediaPipe landmark skeleton *live* during capture, providing instantaneous visual confirmation to the user.
- **Dashboard & Model Explorer:** Visualizes the processed data, displaying metrics, time-series growth trends (KPIs), and interactive **pseudo-3D models** of muscle cross-sections.
- **Posture Validator Feed:** The client receives real-time feedback from the backend

(or calculates it locally) confirming if the user is standing in the correct standardized pose.



2. API Connector Layer

A standard REST API (and potentially WebSockets for real-time visualization feedback) handles JSON communication and the transmission of binary image data between the client and server.

3. FLASK BACKEND Layer

The backend acts as the gateway to the sophisticated analysis engines, defining endpoints for specific user actions.

- **Vision API:** Endpoints for receiving images, initializing pose detection, and running the posture check algorithm.
- **Measurement API:** Endpoints for processing detected landmarks, applying scaling, and calculating physical dimensions.
- **Analytics API:** Endpoints for retrieving historical growth data, calculating percentage changes, and generating trend charts.

4. BUSINESS LOGIC Layer (The Core)

This is where the computer vision and mathematical modeling described in your brief are implemented.

- **Pose Estimation Engine:**
 - *Preprocessing:* Normalizes incoming images for consistent analysis.
 - *MediaPipe Pose Model:* The key component that extracts 33 landmark points.
 - *Posture Validator:* An algorithm that analyzes landmark coordinates (e.g., shoulder tilt, hip alignment) to ensure the standardized capture position is met before accepting the measurement.
- **Measurement & Modeling Engine:**
 - *Scale Calibration:* Implements the conversion logic from pixel distance to centimeters/inches using a reference object or user height.
 - *Geo Modeling:* This is where the multi-view geometric modeling occurs. It combines width (front view) and thickness (side view) measurements to compute muscle cross-sectional area using an elliptical formulation.
- **Growth Analytics Engine:**
 - Processes session-by-session data, filtering outliers, and generating time-

series trends showing muscle volume changes over weeks/months.

5. DATA STORAGE Layer

This layer maintains the immutable ledger of the user's physical progress.

- **session_images:** Secure cloud storage (like AWS S3) for raw or processed capture images (essential for manual review and recalibration).
- **session_pose_data.json:** A log file containing raw landmark coordinate data, which can be re-run through future iterations of the algorithm.
- **body_metrics.db (SQLite):** A relational database containing structured data. It would likely contain tables for: Users, Sessions (timestamp/posture check), Measurements (real-world units), and Pseudo3DModels (elliptical parameters/volumes). This structure ensures repeatable, consistent data retrieval.

IV. METHODOLOGY

The overall workflow follows a linear process to ensure data transformation is systematic and traceable.

1. User Initialization and Input Acquisition.

- **Initialization:** The process begins with the user inputting their height in centimeters, which serves as the primary reference for scaling pixel-based measurements to real-world units.
- **Multi-View Acquisition:** Users capture two distinct perspectives using a standard webcam:
 - **Front View (F):** Used to capture width-based dimensions like shoulder width and arm spread.
 - **Side View (S):** Used to capture thickness-related parameters like chest depth and limb profiles.

2. Computer Vision and Landmark Processing

- **Pose Detection:** The captured frames are processed using the MediaPipe Pose framework to identify 33 anatomical landmarks in real-time.
- **Landmark Extraction:** Only landmarks relevant to hypertrophy—such as shoulders, elbows, hips, and knees—are isolated to minimize computational complexity.
- **Pose Validation:** The system confirms the user's posture before proceeding. For example, it checks if shoulders are parallel in the front view and overlapping in the side view. Invalid poses are rejected to maintain data integrity.

3. Measurement and Mathematical Modeling

- **Distance Computation:** The system calculates the Euclidean distance between pairs of landmarks in pixels.
- **Scaling to Real-World Units:** Pixel measurements are converted to centimeters using a scaling factor derived from the user's height.
 - The formula used is:

$$cm_per_pixel = \frac{0.93 \times user_height}{pixel_height}$$

- **Pseudo-3D Muscle Estimation:** By combining width (\$W\$) from the front view and thickness (\$T\$) from the side view, the system models muscle cross-sections as ellipses to estimate area:

$$Area = \frac{\pi \times W \times T}{4}$$

4. Data Storage and Longitudinal Analysis

- **Structured Storage:** All calculated measurements (arm length, shoulder width, thigh area, etc.) are saved in a tabulated **CSV file** with associated timestamps.
- **Visualization:** The **Visualization Module** generates time-series plots (e.g., Area vs. Time) so users can monitor progress, identify trends, and evaluate training effectiveness over multiple sessions.

5. Methodological Advantages

- **Automation:** Eliminates manual entry and minimizes human error.
- **Consistency:** Pose validation and scaling ensure that results are comparable across different sessions and camera setups.
- **Depth Estimation:** The multi-view approach overcomes the limitations of 2D images by accounting for thickness and volume.
- **Longitudinal Tracking:** Supports long-term monitoring of muscle growth patterns rather than just single-point snapshots.

V. EVALUATION AND RESULTS

The performance of the system was evaluated based on its ability to provide accurate, consistent, and usable measurements for tracking muscle hypertrophy. The experimental testing was conducted using a standard webcam setup on a laptop, with results stored in a structured CSV format for longitudinal analysis.

1. Performance Evaluation Metrics

The system was assessed across three primary areas to determine its effectiveness in a real-life environment:

- **Accuracy:** How closely the AI-generated measurements aligned

with traditional manual tape measurements.

- **Consistency:** The system's ability to produce repeatable results when the same body part was measured multiple times under similar conditions.
- **Usability:** The practicality of using the tool on standard hardware without specialized sensors.

2. Quantitative Results and Comparison

The system demonstrated high accuracy, with an error margin significantly lower than traditional subjective visual checks. A comparison between manual and system-generated measurements revealed the following:

Muscle Tracking System Quantitative Results

Measurement Type	Manual Measure (cm)	System Measure (cm)	Approx. Error (%)
Arm	30	29.4	~2%
Shoulder	42	41.0	~2.3%
Thigh	45	44.0	~2.2%

3. Key Observations

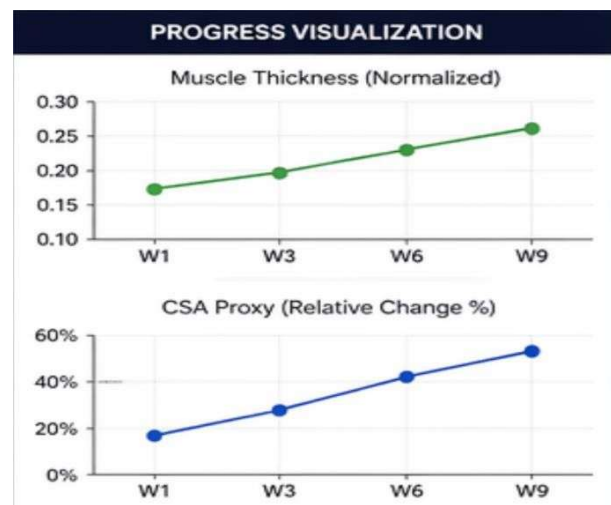
- **Consistency:** The system produced highly consistent outputs as long as the user maintained the same posture and capture conditions.
- **Pose Impact:** Inaccurate posture led to decreased accuracy, highlighting the critical role of the Pose Validation Module in rejecting erroneous captures.
- **Multi-View Efficacy:** Combining front and side views provided much higher fidelity than single-view estimates

by accounting for body depth and thickness.

- **Pseudo-3D Reliability:** While the elliptical model is an approximation, it effectively identified growth trends over time, which is the primary goal of hypertrophy tracking.

4. System Limitations

- **Environmental Sensitivity:** The accuracy of landmark detection can be affected by poor lighting or improper camera angles.
- **Modeling Approximations:** The pseudo-3D elliptical model is a mathematical simplification and does not capture the full, complex anatomy of real muscle forms.
- **User Discipline:** The system relies on the user adhering to standardized capture protocols and maintaining proper posture.



VI. DISCUSSION

- **Computer Vision & Geometry Synergy**

How the integration of MediaPipe landmarks and elliptical modeling bridges 2D visual input and 3D volumetric estimation.

- **Explainable Measurement Logic**

How the scaling factor transforms raw pixel coordinates into interpretable, real-world centimeter measurements for non-technical users.

Validation-Driven Reliability How automated pose alignment checks eliminate manual measurement bottlenecks and human-induced variability.

- **Longitudinal Tracking Value**

How time-series data storage and multi-metric growth visualization add a temporal dimension missing from traditional "static" fitness tools.

- **Honest Limitations**

Environmental sensitivity to lighting, the anatomical simplicity of the elliptical model, and the requirement for standardized user posture acknowledged transparently.

VII. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

The project, "AI-Based Multi-View Landmark-Driven Muscle Hypertrophy Tracking System with Longitudinal Growth Modeling," successfully demonstrates the integration of computer vision and artificial intelligence within the fields of digital anthropometry and fitness tracking. By addressing the subjective and inconsistent nature of traditional manual measurements, the system provides a robust computational framework for monitoring physical progress.

Final Conclusion

- **Automated Framework:** Utilizing the MediaPipe Pose framework, the system identifies 33 anatomical landmarks in real-time to calculate essential body dimensions such as arm length, shoulder width, and thigh length.
- **Measurement Accuracy:** Experimental results indicate a high correlation with manual tape measurements, maintaining a tolerable error margin of approximately 2–3%.
- **Geometric Innovation:** The implementation of a **pseudo-3D elliptical model** allows the system to estimate muscle cross-sectional area, offering a more meaningful representation of hypertrophy than simple linear distances.
- **Validation and Reliability:** An integrated pose validation mechanism ensures data integrity by rejecting improper postures or inconsistent capture conditions, thereby enhancing the credibility of the longitudinal dataset.

Future Scope

While the current system provides a solid foundation, several avenues for future research and development have been identified to enhance its capabilities:

- **Platform Deployment:** Future iterations aim to transition the system into dedicated **web and mobile applications** to improve accessibility and cross-platform compatibility.
- **Cloud Integration:** Implementing a **cloud-based database** would facilitate multi-user support, remote data access, and real-time synchronization across multiple devices.
- **Advanced 3D Modeling:** Integrating **depth sensors** or multi-camera setups could replace the current pseudo-3D approximations with high-fidelity, true 3D volumetric reconstructions.
- **Predictive Analytics:** Utilizing historical data, future versions could incorporate **AI-based prediction models** to forecast growth trends and provide personalized training recommendations.
- **Ecosystem Integration:** The system can be expanded to integrate with wearable devices and existing diet or workout tracking apps to provide a holistic view of user health.

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